WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

CHAD

Africa

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Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
N'Djamena	Capital and seat of government, home to the national investment agency's one-stop shop and the main hub for public procurement under Tchad Connexion 2030	Administration, construction, financial and digital services
Doba basin (south)	Core oil-producing region and origin of the Chad–Cameroon export pipeline; oil output grew 6.6% in 2025 with further projects planned	Oil and gas, oilfield services, power
Chad–Cameroon corridor (Ngueli–Douala / pipeline to Kribi)	Chad's principal route to the sea for crude, imports and mineral exports; Ngueli is the designated customs exit for antimony	Logistics, transport, trade facilitation
Tibesti massif (north)	Identified by the World Bank, BRGM and EITI as holding proven but under-explored critical-mineral potential	Exploration, gold, critical minerals
Mayo-Kebbi (south-west)	Second priority zone for critical-mineral exploration, closer to southern infrastructure and the Cameroon border	Exploration, mining services
Agro-pastoral belt (south and centre)	Agriculture provides about 40% of GDP and Chad holds an estimated 156 million head of livestock and is a leading gum arabic producer	Agro-processing, livestock, cotton, gum arabic
Eastern Chad (Sudan border)	Hosts most of Chad's 1.5 million refugees and asylum seekers, attracting substantial donor-financed programmes	Water, energy, logistics, development-financed services

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Agence pour la Promotion des Investissements et des Exportations (ANIE), the national investment and export agency, with a one-stop shop (Guichet Unique) for company registration and online file tracking
- National Investment Charter granting foreign investors equal treatment, protection against expropriation except in the public interest, and five-year tax exemptions for qualifying new industrial, mining, agricultural, forestry and real-estate activities
- OHADA uniform business law and CEMAC membership, providing a harmonised commercial-law framework used across much of francophone Africa

- CFA franc (XAF) issued by the regional central bank BEAC and pegged to the euro, with cross-border transfers governed by CEMAC foreign-exchange regulations through licensed banks
- Tchad Connexion 2030 national development plan: 268 projects and reforms seeking $30 billion, with project and co-investment opportunities across energy, agriculture, mining, infrastructure and digital services
- Mining entry through partnership with SONEMIC and Ministry-approved licences for critical minerals, under a 12.5% royalty paid via the E-tax digital platform
- Oil-sector participation alongside the state oil company SHT, with a preferential tax regime for contractors and subcontractors on major oil projects

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Chad enters late 2026 with solid growth momentum and improving public finances. The World Bank reports GDP growth of 5.6% in 2025, well above the CEMAC average of 2.8%, with agriculture up 4.9%, services up 5% and oil output up 6.6%, while average inflation fell to -2.6% on stronger harvests. The budget deficit narrowed to 1.7% of GDP and public debt eased to 30.2% of GDP. In June 2026 the World Bank raised its 2026 growth forecast by 1.5 points to 5.2%, the largest upgrade in Africa, and first-quarter 2026 exports rose 29% on gold and antimony. Reforms are anchored by an IMF Extended Credit Facility of about $655 million approved in July 2025, and the Tchad Connexion 2030 plan has mobilised $20.5 billion in pledges and agreements, including 40 private-sector agreements worth $4.1 billion. UNCTAD puts the FDI stock at around $9.3 billion, although recorded annual inflows have been heavily revised and were modest in 2024–2025.

Chad's main structural challenge is its reliance on oil, which provides about 41% of government revenue and 76% of exports, leaving public finances sensitive to oil prices; the 2026 budget assumes oil revenue falls 22% to about 35% of total revenue. The government is responding with practical diversification: non-oil revenue rose 23.7% in 2025 on mandatory e-payment of taxes and customs reform, an oil revenue audit is being published under the IMF programme, and mining has been placed under a clearer state framework for critical minerals, with gold production up 25.6% and antimony up 49% in early 2026. Agriculture, which accounts for about 40% of GDP, and one of Africa's largest livestock herds offer a broad base for agro-processing. For investors, this transition creates entry points in mining, agribusiness, power and logistics, while a national oil strategy targeting 250,000 barrels a day by 2030 keeps the hydrocarbons sector open to experienced partners.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Oil revenue dependence	Oil accounts for about 41% of public revenue and 76% of exports, so price movements feed quickly into public spending and payments	Strong non-oil revenue growth and IMF-supported fiscal reforms are broadening the base; non-oil sectors offer the most diversified exposure
Contract and resource-sector policy	The state took control of former ExxonMobil upstream assets in 2023 after a disputed sale, and in 2026 centralised licensing of critical minerals	Secure clear ministerial approvals, international arbitration clauses and political-risk cover (for example IsDB's ICIEC); early, transparent engagement builds durable partnerships
Regional security and the Sudan conflict	Chad hosts about 1.5 million refugees and asylum seekers, and the Sudan border was closed in February 2026 after clashes	Locate operations in the capital, south and established corridors with professional security planning; donor-funded programmes in the east create service opportunities
Landlocked logistics	Distance to the sea raises freight costs by around 50%, and each extra day in transit adds about 0.8% to the value of goods	Use the Douala corridor and plan inventory buffers; Tchad Connexion 2030 road, airport and trade-facilitation investment creates logistics opportunities
Banking-sector depth	Only five of ten banks met all prudential norms in 2025 and non-performing loans reached 42.8% of loans	Use regional or DFI financing and trade finance (for example IsDB's ITFC); IMF-backed public bank restructuring is under way
Debt-distress rating	Public debt is moderate at about 30% of	The ECF programme, reduced commercial

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	GDP, but the IMF rates the risk of external debt distress as high	debt and concessional financing support stability; structure payment terms with DFI or guarantee support
Business environment and informality	About 88% of jobs are informal and service delivery and infrastructure remain thin outside the main cities	Work through ANIE's one-stop shop, OHADA-compliant structures and experienced local partners

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Chad's risk profile reflects an economy with strong recent growth, falling inflation, moderate public debt and an active IMF-supported reform programme, alongside the challenges of oil dependence, a landlocked position and a demanding regional security environment. Investors should note plainly that the 2023 takeover of former ExxonMobil oil assets and the 2026 centralisation of critical-mineral licensing show the state's intention to retain strong control over natural resources; agreements should therefore be built on clear ministerial approvals, international arbitration provisions and political-risk insurance. The IMF rates the risk of external debt distress as high, although debt fell to about 30% of GDP in 2025 and commercial borrowing has been reduced. The Sudan conflict and refugee inflows require careful site selection and security planning in the east. Against this, the $20.5 billion mobilised for Tchad Connexion 2030, strong multilateral backing and fast-growing gold, antimony and agricultural exports point to a widening opportunity set for well-advised, patient investors.

MARKET ACCESS

Chad is a member of the Central African Economic and Monetary Community (CEMAC) and the Economic Community of Central African States (ECCAS), giving access to a regional market with a shared currency, the CFA franc, which is pegged to the euro. It has been a WTO member since 1996, and a GATT contracting party since 1963, and applies OHADA business law in common with much of francophone Africa. Crude oil, around three-quarters of exports, flows through the Chad–Cameroon pipeline to the Atlantic terminal at Kribi, while most other trade moves along the road corridor to the port of Douala via the Ngueli crossing. Gold, antimony, livestock, gum arabic and other agricultural products are a growing share of exports, and Tchad Connexion 2030 prioritises road, airport and trade-facilitation investment to reduce transit costs and strengthen Chad's role as a crossroads between Central, West and North-East Africa.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (Mahamat Idriss Déby Itno)	Sets national strategy, including the Tchad Connexion 2030 development plan and resource-sector policy	Primary reference point for strategic direction and major partnerships
ANIE (Agence pour la Promotion des Investissements et des Exportations)	National investment and export promotion agency operating the Guichet Unique one-stop shop	Standard first point of contact for market entry, registration and incentives
Ministry of Finance, Budget, Economy, Planning and International Cooperation (Tahir Hamid Nguilin)	Leads the IMF programme, the budget and the coordination and financing of Tchad Connexion 2030	Key counterpart for project pipeline, PPPs and fiscal incentives
Ministry of Petroleum, Mines and Geology	Approves licences for oil and critical minerals and sets resource-sector rules	Essential for any upstream oil or mining engagement
Société des Hydrocarbures du Tchad (SHT)	State oil company and partner in upstream and pipeline assets	Central counterpart for oil-sector partnerships and services
SONEMIC (national mining company)	State mining and marketing company aiming to make Chad a mining country by 2030	Partner for exploration and mining joint ventures
Banque des États de l'Afrique Centrale (BEAC)	Regional central bank for CEMAC; issues the CFA franc and administers foreign-exchange rules through its national	Relevant for currency, transfers and banking matters

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
	directorate	

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

Multilateral partners are the most active convening channels in Chad. The World Bank, IMF and African Development Bank support fiscal, agricultural and infrastructure programmes, while the Islamic Development Bank Group, through ICIEC, ICD and ITFC, offers blended finance, trade finance and risk cover and held an IsDB Day with the government in N'Djamena in January 2026. The UAE–Chad Trade and Investment Forum in Abu Dhabi, which launched Tchad Connexion 2030 in November 2025, the Chad–France economic forum scheduled in Paris for September 2026 and the SEMICA Tchad mines and hydrocarbons fair provide regular access to decision-makers. The EU-Africa Chamber of Commerce and the US Embassy, which has engaged SONEMIC on mining cooperation, are further useful channels for Western investors.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Chad best suits investors with experience in frontier markets and a long-term horizon: mining companies and critical-minerals specialists prepared to partner with SONEMIC under the new licensing framework; agribusiness, livestock and food-processing investors building on a large agricultural base; energy and power developers responding to the plan's 90% urban electricity-access target; and logistics and construction firms positioned for donor- and state-financed infrastructure. Development finance institutions, Gulf investors and impact funds are well placed to lead, while experienced oil-service and upstream partners can engage alongside SHT with robust contractual protection.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage ANIE and the Ministry of Finance
Open dialogue with ANIE on registration and incentives and with the Ministry of Finance on Tchad Connexion 2030 projects matching your sector.

STEP 2: Structure contracts for durability
Secure ministerial approvals, OHADA-compliant structures, international arbitration clauses and political-risk cover before committing capital.

STEP 3: Partner with development finance institutions
Co-invest or seek guarantees from the World Bank Group, African Development Bank or IsDB Group to share risk and strengthen counterparty standing.

STEP 4: Plan logistics and security from the outset
Map routes through the Douala corridor and Ngueli crossing, budget for transit time, and commission professional security assessments for sites outside the capital.

STEP 5: Target diversification sectors
Prioritise mining, agro-processing, power and logistics, where government reforms and donor programmes are creating the strongest near-term demand.